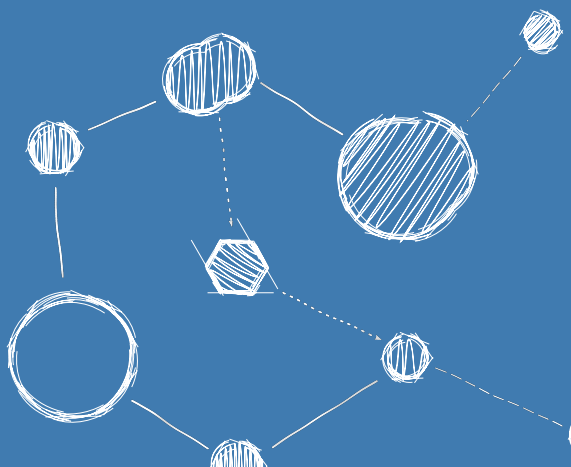
institut für astrophysik
UNIVERSITÄTSSTERNWARTE WIEN

universität wien

SPW_BRIDGE – A SPACEWIRE TO NETWORK BRIDGE FOR GROUND SUPPORT EQUIPMENT

User Manual



User Manual

Reference: SPW_BRIDGE-UVIE-UM-001

Version: Issue 1.1, September 10, 2026

Prepared by: Armin Luntzer[1]

Checked by: Roland Ottensamer[1]

Approved by: Franz Kerschbaum[1]

[1] Department of Astrophysics, University of Vienna

Copyright ©2026

Permission is granted to copy, distribute and/or modify this document under the terms of the GNU Free Documentation License, Version 1.3 or any later version published by the Free Software Foundation; with no Front-Cover, no Logos of the University of Vienna.

Contents

1 Introduction **5**
1.1 Purpose of the Document . . . 5

2 Applicable and Reference Documents **6**

3 Terms, Definitions and Abbreviated Items **7**
3.1 Acronyms . . . 7
3.2 Glossary . . . 7

4 Software Overview **9**
4.1 Function and Purpose . . . 9
4.2 Build Requirements . . . 9
4.3 Build System . . . 9
4.4 Source and Support Documentation . . . 10
4.5 Current Platform Configuration . . . 10
4.6 Features Overview . . . 10

5 Structure and Concept **12**
5.1 Source Code Organisation . . . 12
5.2 Network Subsystem . . . 12
5.3 SpaceWire Subsystem . . . 13
5.4 RMAP Helper Functions . . . 13
5.5 GRESB Support . . . 13
5.6 ECSS Packet Library . . . 14
5.7 Block Diagram . . . 14
5.8 Data Flow . . . 15

6 Using the Bridge **16**
6.1 Synopsis . . . 16
6.2 Operating Modes . . . 16
6.3 SpaceWire Configuration . . . 17
6.4 Interpreting the Network Stream . . . 17
6.5 Monitor Mode . . . 18
6.6 Reading the Monitor Mode Printout . . . 18
6.7 Packet Sniffer . . . 19
6.8 Keyboard Control of the Debug Printout . . . 20
6.9 Reading the PUS Debug Printout . . . 20
6.10 The PUS CRC16 Check . . . 21
6.11 The Pseudo-RMAP Interface . . . 21

6.12 Examples 22
6.12.1 Server Mode with a PCIe Card 22
6.12.2 Link Monitoring 22
6.12.3 Brick MK II Configuration 22
6.12.4 Use in the CHEOPS EGSE 23
6.12.5 Use in the ARIEL Mission 23
6.12.6 GRESB Protocol with grmon 23

Revision History

Revision	Date	Author(s)	Description
1.0	10.09.2026	AL	Initial version
1.1	10.09.2026	AL	add monitor mode bridging two SpaceWire channels with RMAP decoding, payload suppression, a short debug form, sequence checking in the debug printout, native GRESB virtual link transmit and receive ports with selectable virtual link, GRESB and RMAP payload debug output, read command decoding, a selectable RMAP decode detail level, a GRESB traffic sniffer port and the printout of the header bytes dropped from received SpaceWire packets

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of the Document

This document gives an overview on how to build, configure and use the SpW bridge software. An overview of the structure of the software will be given; detailed information relevant to system programming must however be looked up in the in-line documentation of the source files. The main text describes the generic bridging machinery that the software provides, the command-line interface, and the packet formats exchanged with a peer on the network side.

2. Applicable and Reference Documents

[1] *ECSS-E-70-41A Space engineering - Ground systems and operations - Telemetry and telecommand packet utilization standard*. ESA Requirements and Standards Division, 2003.

[2] *ECSS-E-ST-50-12C Space engineering - SpaceWire - Links, nodes, routers and networks*. ESA Requirements and Standards Division, 2008.

[3] *ECSS-E-ST-50-52C Space engineering - SpaceWire - Remote memory access protocol*. ESA Requirements and Standards Division, 2010.

[4] *ECSS-E-ST-70-41C Space engineering - Telemetry and telecommand packet utilization*. ESA Requirements and Standards Division, 2016.

[5] *GR712RC Dual-Core LEON3FT SPARC V8 Processor User's Manual*. 2016.

[6] *GR740 Quad-Core LEON4FT SPARC V8 Processor Technical Reference Manual*. 2021.

[7] *GRESB User's Manual*. 2017.

[8] *GRMON2 User's Manual*. 2018.

[9] *MSSL-IF-109: Format for the downlink of FEE data packets*. Version Draft A.14. as referenced by the FEE frame counter fields in net.c. Mullard Space Science Laboratory.

[10] *Space Packet Protocol*. Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems, 2012.

3. Terms, Definitions and Abbreviated Items

3.1 Acronyms

CCSDS Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems
CRC Cyclic Redundancy Check
ECSS European Cooperation for Space Standardization
EGSE Electrical Ground Support Equipment
EOP End Of Packet
FEE Front-End Electronics
GCC GNU Compiler Collection
PUS Packet Utilisation Standard
RMAP Remote Memory Access Protocol
TCP Transmission Control Protocol
UDP User Datagram Protocol

3.2 Glossary

Doxygen

Doxygen is a documentation generator for writing software reference documentation.

GR712RC

The GR712RC is a dual-core LEON3-FT system-on-chip manufactured by Gaisler [5].

GRESB

The GRESB is a SpaceWire/Ethernet bridge by Gaisler that routes SpaceWire packets to and from TCP sockets over an Ethernet network; it offers three SpaceWire links and six virtual links [7].

LEON3-FT

The LEON3-FT is a fault-tolerant version of the LEON3. Changes to the base version include autonomous error handling, cache locking and different cache replacement strategies.

MSSL

The Mullard Space Science Laboratory is a department of University College London; on CHEOPS it provides the science payload, whose FEE data frames follow MSSL-IF-109 [9].

SpaceWire

SpaceWire is a spacecraft communication network based in part on the IEEE 1355 standard of communications.

SpW

SpW is a common abbreviation of SpaceWire used throughout this document.

STAR API

The STAR API is the software interface to SpaceWire interface devices such as the Brick MK II, Brick MK III, PCI and PCIe cards; `spw_bridge` uses it for all device, channel and link management.

4. Software Overview

4.1 Function and Purpose

`spw_bridge` is a software bridge between a SpaceWire link and a network connection to a workstation. It operates a SpaceWire interface device through the STAR API API and relays packets between the SpW link and a Transmission Control Protocol (TCP)/IP or User Datagram Protocol (UDP) endpoint, in either direction.

On the SpW side, the software uses the STAR API to select a device and channel, to set the link signalling rate and to submit and receive packets via the STAR transfer-operation machinery. On the network side, it provides a mult iple-connection server, a single-connection client, or a UDP endpoint. The bridge may optionally interpret the carried data stream: Packet Utilisation Standard (PUS) packets, Front-End Electronics (FEE) data frames, GRESB protocol packets, and a pseudo-Remote Memory Access Protocol (RMAP) command interface are supported and are described below.

The intended use is ground support equipment, e.g. to operate the front-end electronics of an instrument through a SpaceWire-to-Ethernet path from a workstation, or to debug a LEON3-FT-based target such as a GR712RC through the RMAP protocol.

4.2 Build Requirements

In order to build `spw_bridge`, make sure you have set up your environment so that the STAR API tools are available. The build currently links against the shared libraries

```
-lstar-api -lrmap_packet_library -lstar_conf_api_generic
-lstar_conf_api_mk2 -lstar_conf_api_brick_mk2
-lstar_conf_api_brick_mk3 -lstar_conf_api_pcie_mk2
```

together with `-lpthread`. The matching headers are found under `star-system/inc/star` and are provided by the STAR API installation. You will also need a GNU Compiler Collection (GCC) compiler for your host platform, GNU make and a bash shell, i.e. what you would typically find in a Linux distribution with a basic set of development tools installed. If you want to generate source code documentation, you will also need to install Doxygen.
The STAR API API, the RMAP packet library and the device configuration libraries are supplied by STAR-Dundee Ltd. as part of the support software of their SpaceWire devices; obtain them from STAR-Dundee if you are a customer who acquired one of their devices.

4.3 Build System

The build is driven by the plain Makefile in the source root. To build the binary, simply issue

```
$ make
```

on your shell prompt from the top-level `spw_bridge` directory. The build produces an executable named *spw_bridge* in the current directory. To remove the build output, use

```
$ make clean
```

The optional `DEBUG` variable controls the verbosity of the debug output. By default it is set to 1, which disables the per-packet `DBG` traces. Setting `DEBUG` to 2 or higher enables them:

```
$ make DEBUG=2
```

4.4 Source and Support Documentation

The source files carry Doxygen-style in-line documentation. The STAR API API header set and its reference documentation are kept below `star-system/`, with the generated Doxygen HTML under `star-system/doc`. The reference standards drawn upon by the packet handling code are listed in Chapter 2.

4.5 Current Platform Configuration

The bridge is a host-side application and runs on a Linux workstation. The STAR API device selected by default is device number 0; the device enumeration performed at startup lists the detected devices and their names. A channel number between 0 and 31 may be selected; the default channel is 1. The link signalling rate is set to 10 Mbit/s by default and may be configured between 2 and 400 Mbit/s. Channels, link identifiers and routing paths are under configuration control through the command-line options described in Chapter 6.

4.6 Features Overview

The following gives a concise overview of the currently implemented features:

- Network transport over a single TCP connection (server or client mode) or over UDP datagrams.
- Interpretation of the network byte stream into PUS packets (ECSS-E-ST-70-41C) with sequence counting and CRC16 verification in both directions.
- Decoded printing of Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems (CCSDS) and PUS-C header fields, the per-packet CRC16 status and the payloads for debugging.
- Interpretation of FEE data frames (with the FEE framing of MSSL Draft A.14).

- Support for the GRESB protocol, intended for use with the grmon debug monitor for RMAP access to a target.

- A pseudo-RMAP command service on a dedicated TCP port for lossless read and write access to the SpW network.

- Optional stripping of a fixed number of leading bytes of incoming SpW packets (e.g. a path header added by the network).

- Optional throttling of SpW packet submission by an inserted delay between packets.

- Optional device reset on startup.

- Monitor mode: verbatim copying of packets between two SpW channels of the same device, with the network side acting as a passive observer.

- A packet sniffer on the GRESB traffic sniffer port: a mirror of all data received or sent on the network interface and on the GRESB ports, in raw or GRESB-encapsulated form.

5. Structure and Concept

5.1 Source Code Organisation

The bridge consists of a small set of dedicated source files:

`spw_bridge.c`	main program: option processing, startup and shutdown
`spw_bridge.h`	shared configuration and subsystem interfaces
`net.c`	network subsystem: sockets, framing, packet sink
`spw.c`	SpaceWire subsystem: STAR API device, link handling and the monitor mode packet sink
`kbd.c`, `kbd.h`	keyboard monitor: toggles the debug printout and the short debug form
`rmap.c`, `rmap.h`	RMAP command and reply helper functions
`gresb.c`, `gresb.h`	GRESB protocol packet helpers
`byteorder.h`	endianness conversion macros
`debug.h`	debug output control
`ecss/`	CCSDS, ECSS (PUS) and CRC packet library

The two subsystems talk to each other through the `bridge_cfg` structure: the network code installs a packet sink callback (`cfg->pkt_sink = net_pkt_sink`) that the SpW receive loop invokes for every complete packet received on the link.

5.2 Network Subsystem

The network subsystem maintains a per-service fds set and multiplexes its connections with `select()`. Two services exist: the *data* service carries the forwarded SpW packets, and the *rmap* service implements the pseudo-RMAP interface (see Section 6.11). Each service has its own accept and poll thread; the RMAP service is always started as a listening server, even when the data path runs in client mode. A peer that stays silent for more than 30 seconds is dropped.

Depending on the selected mode, a received network byte stream is framed as follows:

- *raw*: one `recv()` call defines one SpW packet. Note that back-to-back packets sent on a stream socket may be merged into a single receive, and a partially delivered packet may be split, so a higher-level framing protocol is normally required for reliable transport.

- *PUS* (`-P`): a six-byte CCSDS primary header is read first; the packet length field plus one octet plus the six-byte header defines the packet boundary. The sequence counter in bytes 2 and 3 is checked against the running sequence in both directions and mismatches are reported on `stderr`.

- *FEE* (`-F`): a ten-byte FEE data header is expected; if its protocol identifier is `0xF0`, the big-endian data length field plus the header defines the packet boundary. A different

protocol identifier defers to raw framing.

- *GRESB* (`-G`): a four-byte host-to-GRESB header (protocol byte plus three-byte big-endian size) defines the packet boundary.

In the other direction, every packet received on the SpW link is passed to `net_pkt_sink`, which forwards it to all connected data clients. In GRESB mode the SpW packet is wrapped into a host-to-GRESB data packet before transmission.

5.3 SpaceWire Subsystem

The SpW subsystem selects the STAR device and channel, optionally resets the device, sets the link signalling rate through `CFG_setTransmitSignallingRate`, opens the channel and creates the routing path with `STAR_createAddress`. The link is then forced into the running state and the measured receive rate is reported.

A dedicated polling thread is started which repeatedly submits a single receive transfer operation (`STAR_createRxOperation` with `EOP` terminated packets) and waits for its completion. On completion the received packet is handed to the network sink. Transmission uses `STAR_createPacket` plus a transmit transfer operation, with an optional throttle delay after each packet. Reads and writes of registers on remote targets are implemented with the STAR RMAP packet library, see below.
In monitor mode (Section 6.5) two channels of the device are opened instead of one, each polled by its own thread; received packets are copied to the other channel without a routing header.

5.4 RMAP Helper Functions

The RMAP helper sources provide verification, CRC-8 computation, and parsing of RMAP packets, including a table of the command codes and status codes of ECSS ECSS-E-ST-50-52C. The bridge uses these helpers to parse RMAP packets for logging and to decode replies received from targets on the SpW link.

5.5 GRESB Support

The GRESB is a SpaceWire-to-Ethernet bridge intended for ground equipment (see the GRESB glossary entry and [7]). The bridge implements its host protocol: a data transfer consists of a one-byte protocol identifier followed by a three-byte big-endian size field and the raw SpW data. The reverse direction carries a header with reserved, truncated and End Of Packet

(EOP)-error bits followed by the three-byte size and the data.

The GRESB uses a base port number of 3000 with two ports per virtual link: the even port is the transmit port and the odd port is the receive port. Up to five virtual links are supported (0 to 5). With the `-G` option the bridge raises the two ports of the selected virtual link (default 0, i.e. 3000 and 3001) directly next to the regular network port: the transmit port only sends copies of the GRESB packets that would be transmitted via the default port, the receive port only receives packets which could also be received via the default port. The virtual link is selected with the optional `LINKID` argument, e.g. `-G3` raises ports 3006 and 3007. No external forwarding of the ports is required. This mode is intended to be used with the grmon debug monitor for RMAP access (see Section 6.12.6).

5.6 ECSS Packet Library

The `ecss/` directory contains a self-contained packet library that follows the CCSDS Space Packet Protocol [10] and the PUS [4]:

- `ccsds_pkt.c/h` – field accessors and setters for the six-byte CCSDS primary header (version, type, secondary header flag, APID, sequence flags and count, data length).
- `ecss_pkt.c/h` – PUS-A and PUS-C secondary header handling, verification support, source and destination identifiers, timestamps, and a service/sub-service model. The active PUS version is configured in `ecss_pkt_cfg.h`.
- `ecss_pkt_cfg.h` – configuration and service type / sub-service definitions (ST_VER, ST_HK, ST_EVT, ST_Mem, ST_Time, and so on). The current configuration tracks PUS-C as the baseline and defines a maximum packet size of 4096 bytes.
- `crc16.c/h` – CRC16-CCITT-FALSE with a slice-by-8 lookup table and a benchmark suite.
- `bitman.c/h` – bit-level field extraction used by the packet library.

The `pus_debug_print()` function uses this library to print decoded CCSDS and PUS-C headers and payloads for both directions when enabled with `-D` and `-P`. The CRC16 check on the data path is performed with `crc16_buf()` from the same library (see Section 6.10).

5.7 Block Diagram

Figure 5.1 shows the connectivity design of the bridge. Ground support equipment, a grmon debug monitor or a GRESB device exchange data with the bridge over Ethernet (TCP/IP or UDP).

The network side of the bridge frames the received byte streams according to the selected packet mode, the relaying core hands the packets to the SpW side, which submits them through a STAR API API device onto the SpaceWire link, and the same path is used in reverse for packets received from the link.

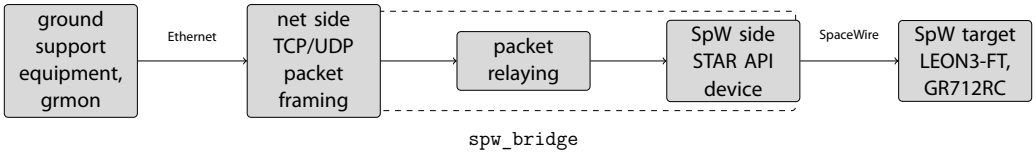


Figure 5.1: Block diagram of the `spw_bridge` connectivity

5.8 Data Flow

In the *network to SpaceWire* direction, a poll thread waits for data on the data service, frames it according to the selected mode, logs it, and hands it to `spw_send_packet` which transmits it on the SpW link (see Figure 5.1). The rmap service instead parses a pseudo-RMAP command header (see Section 6.11) and issues the corresponding read or write command.

In the *SpaceWire to network* direction, the SpW polling thread receives a packet and calls `net_pkt_sink`. Depending on the configuration, the packet is logged, its PUS sequence is checked, and any RMAP replies (identified by the RMAP protocol identifier byte after the skipped header) are forwarded to the RMAP service clients. The data is then forwarded to the data service clients, optionally wrapped in a GRESB packet.
With the `-W` sniffer option, every packet received or sent on the network interface and on the GRESB ports is additionally mirrored to the connected sniffer clients (see Section 6.7); the pseudo-RMAP service traffic is excluded.

6. Using the Bridge

6.1 Synopsis

```
$ ./spw_bridge [OPTIONS]
```

The bridge runs until it is interrupted; `SIGINT`, `SIGTERM` and `SIGHUP` terminate the program and shut down the device cleanly. The full option set is:

`-i DEVNUM`	SpW device id to use (default 0)
`-c CHANNEL`	SpW channel to use (default 1)
`-n PATH`	routing path, colon-separated hex bytes, one byte per node
`-p PORT`	local data port number (default 1234)
`-s ADDRESS`	local source address (default 0.0.0.0)
`-r HOST:PORT`	client mode: address and port of the remote target
`-u`	use UDP instead of TCP
`-d NUM`	number of header bytes to drop from incoming SpW packets (default 0); with `-D` the dropped
`-t USEC`	throttle: delay in microseconds inserted before each SpW packet (default 0)
`-S MBPS`	link speed in Mbit/s (default 10, valid range 2–400)
`-L LINKID`	id of the link whose speed is set (default: equal to the channel)
`-P`	parse the network byte stream for PUS packets
`-D`	print decoded PUS-C headers and payloads (requires `-P`); with the GRESB option prints the pay
`-N`	suppress payload bytes in the debug printout (short form)
`-C`	disable the PUS CRC16 check (see Section 6.10)
`-F`	parse the network byte stream for FEE data packets
`-R [PORT]`	enable the pseudo–RMAP service on PORT (default 2345)
`-M C1:C2`	monitor mode: bridge the given SpW channels, copying packets verbatim between them
`-E [LEVEL]`	decode RMAP packets in the debug printout (requires `-M` or `-G` and `-D`); level 1 prints the head
`-G [LINKID]`	use the GRESB protocol, opening the transmit and receive ports of GRESB virtual link LINKID (d
`-W [FORMAT]`	sniff all bridge traffic on the GRESB traffic sniffer port 3064; bare `-W` forwards the raw stream, -
`-X`	perform a device reset before opening the channel
`-h`, `--help`	print the usage message and exit

A routing path given with `-n` is a colon-separated list of hex byte values, one per node (e.g. `-n 01:24:00:00:00`); up to 256 nodes are accepted and out-of-range values are truncated to 8 bits.

6.2 Operating Modes

The bridge supports three modes of operation:

- *server mode* (default): the bridge listens on the configured address and port for an arbitrary number of TCP connections. Every connected peer receives the SpW traffic, and

data from any peer is transmitted on the SpW link.

- *client mode* (`-r`): the bridge connects to the specified `HOST:PORT` and operates a single connection. If the link is lost, the bridge terminates.

- *UDP mode* (`-u`): the bridge binds a UDP socket and sends one datagram per SpW packet. Peers are registered as they are seen, i.e. the first datagram from a host registers it as a recipient.

6.3 SpaceWire Configuration

At startup the bridge lists the detected STAR API devices and their names. The device is selected with `-i` (default 0). The channel is selected with `-c`; a non-existent channel is rejected and the available channels are printed. The link signalling rate is set with `-S` to a value between 2 and 400 Mbit/s; the actual, measured receive rate is reported during link start. `-L` selects the link whose speed is set; on the Brick MK II the transmit signalling rate of the second port is configured in this way. `-X` resets the device before the channel is opened; note that this affects other ports of the device as well.

6.4 Interpreting the Network Stream

By default the network byte stream is forwarded without framing (raw mode); please note the packet merging and splitting caveat described in Section 5.2. For reliable transport of packet-oriented traffic, use one of the packet modes:

- `-P` frames the stream as PUS packets, checks the CCSDS sequence counter in both directions and verifies the PUS CRC16 (see Section 6.10). The next expected value is tracked per APID and always advances to the received value plus one (with wrap-around at 14 bits); a previously unseen APID starts tracking at the received value plus one. A sequence mismatch is reported together with the expected and received counter values in the PUS debug printout (Section 6.9) and is only shown when `-D` is active.

- `-F` frames the stream as FEE data packets (protocol identifier `0xF0`). All other packets fall back to raw framing.

- `-G` frames the stream as GRESB protocol packets (see Section 6.12.6).

`-D` additionally prints a decoded CCSDS and PUS-C header and payload dump of every packet passing through the bridge, in both directions. It requires `-P`; once enabled, the printout can also be switched on and off from the keyboard while the bridge is running (see Section 6.8).
`-N` restricts the printout to the decoded header lines and suppresses the raw payload dump. Like the printout itself, the short form can be toggled from the keyboard while the bridge is running (see Section 6.8).

6.5 Monitor Mode

Monitor mode turns the bridge into a passive tap between two SpW channels of the same device. It is enabled with `-M CHANNEL1:CHANNEL2`; the two colon-separated channel numbers select the physical SpW ports to be bridged. The two channels must differ.
In this mode every packet received on one channel is copied verbatim to the other, without adding or stripping a routing header and without any interpretation on the forwarding path. The bridge neither inserts routing bytes nor drops packet headers, and the forwarded SpW transactions remain atomic. The network side works as before, but it only observes: all data received from the network is discarded, and the connected clients receive a mirror of the copied SpW traffic in both directions. The channel selection `-c` and the header-drop option `-d` are ignored; the routing path given with `-n` is not applied to the copied packets. The link signalling rate set with `-S` is applied to both channels.
With `-D`, the debug printout shows the direction of the copied packet as `SPW[A]->SPW[B]` instead of the network directions, followed by a hex dump of the raw packet payload. With the additional `-E` option the packets are decoded as RMAP and a header line is printed in front of the payload dump (see Section 6.6); `-E2` adds a detail line with the instruction, the reply path and the data words. A packet that cannot be parsed as RMAP only shows the raw payload dump. `-N` suppresses the payload dump (the short form); the direction line and, with `-E`, the decoded RMAP header line (and, at level 2, the detail line) are still printed. No PUS interpretation is performed on the monitor path, and packets are never modified by the decoding.

6.6 Reading the Monitor Mode Printout

In monitor mode, the debug printout of every copied packet is preceded by a time stamp and the direction of travel, using the actual channel numbers of the bridge (e.g. `SPW[1]->SPW[2]` for a packet received on channel 1 and copied to channel 2). Without `-E` the packet is shown as a raw hex dump of its payload:

```
[2026-09-10 10:20:30.512] SPW[1]->SPW[2]
  payload (18 bytes):
  00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 0a 0b 0c 0d 0e 0f
  10 11
```

With `-E`, a decoded RMAP header line is printed in front of the payload dump; a write command and the matching read reply, for example, look like

```
[2026-09-10 10:20:30.512] SPW[1]->SPW[2]
```

```
  RMAP: CMD WRITE dst=0xfe key=0xab src=0x30 tr_id=1 addr=0x00001000 data_len=2
      hdr_crc=0x1b data_crc=0x4a
  payload (19 bytes):
  00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 0a 0b 0c 0d 0e 0f
  10 11 12

[2026-09-10 10:20:32.013] SPW[2]->SPW[1]
  RMAP: REPLY READ dst=0x30 key=0x00 src=0xfe tr_id=1 addr=0x00001000 data_len=5
      hdr_crc=0x77 data_crc=0x2c
  payload (22 bytes):
  00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 0a 0b 0c 0d 0e 0f
  10 11 12 13 14 15
```

Read commands carry no data field, so their requested length appears as `data_len` and no data CRC is printed. With `-E2`, a detail line follows the header line, showing the instruction field, the reply path and the data words of a packet that carries data:

```
[2026-09-10 10:20:29.880] SPW[1]->SPW[2]
  RMAP: CMD READ dst=0xfe key=0xab src=0x30 tr_id=2 addr=0x00001000 data_len=4 hdr_crc
      =0x5e data_crc=0x00
  RMAP: instruction=0x48 cmd=0x2 read single rpath=none
[2026-09-10 10:20:31.204] SPW[2]->SPW[1]
  RMAP: REPLY READ dst=0x30 key=0x00 src=0xfe tr_id=2 addr=0x00000000 data_len=4
      hdr_crc=0x77 data_crc=0x2c
  RMAP: instruction=0x08 cmd=0x2 read single rpath=none
  RMAP: data (4 bytes): deadbeef
```

The printed fields are

`SPW[A]->SPW[B]`	direction of travel: the channel the packet was received on, and the channel it is copied to
`CMD`, `REPLY`	whether the packet is an RMAP command or a reply
`WRITE`, `READ`	the operation of an RMAP command
`dst`, `src`	target and initiator logical addresses
`key`	command authorisation key (status field in replies)
`tr_id`	transaction identifier
`addr`	(first) data address
`data_len`	length of the RMAP data field in octets
`hdr_crc`, `data_crc`	the header and data CRC-8 values carried by the packet
`instruction`	raw instruction octet (level 2)
`cmd`	four-bit command code, followed by the read/write operation and the increment and ver
`rpath`	reply path bytes, or `none` (level 2)
`data`	data field as 32-bit words; omitted when the packet carries no data (level 2)

A packet that cannot be parsed as RMAP carries no RMAP header line and only its payload is dumped. In the short form (`-N`) the payload dump is suppressed: only the time stamp, the direction and, with `-E`, the decoded RMAP header line are printed. The payload itself is formatted as in the PUS printout (Section 6.9): hex octets, sixteen per line, with an empty line closing the dump.

6.7 Packet Sniffer

The `-W` option opens a sniffer port on the machine running the bridge: it listens on port 3064, the port the GRESB reserves for its traffic sniffer. Every packet received or sent on the regular

network interface port, as well as every packet received or sent on the configured GRESB virtual link ports, is mirrored to the connected sniffer clients. The stream is deduplicated: a packet that the bridge relays onto both the network interface and a GRESB port is forwarded only once. The traffic of the pseudo-RMAP service (Section 6.11) is excluded, so the sniffed content only contains PUS, GRESB and raw RMAP data. The option works with any configuration, independent of the GRESB option.
By default the packets are forwarded as raw octets and the client is expected to do any decoding itself. With the optional format argument `-Wg` each packet is wrapped in a GRESB container instead (a one-byte protocol identifier followed by the three-byte big-endian size field and the SpW data).

```
$ ./spw_bridge -c 1 -W          # raw sniff stream on port 3064
$ ./spw_bridge -c 1 -G -Wg      # GRESB-encapsulated sniff stream
```

6.8 Keyboard Control of the Debug Printout

When `-D` is active, the decoded debug printout can be toggled from the terminal while the bridge is running: pressing `d` or `D` turns it on or off, and each change is announced on the terminal with a `PUS debug enabled` or `PUS debug disabled` message. This allows a quick look at the PUS traffic without restarting the bridge or resubmitting the command line. Likewise, `s` or `S` toggles the short form of the printout, which suppresses the payload dump; the change is announced with a `short debug form enabled` or `short debug form disabled` message. The keyboard control is handled by a dedicated monitor thread and requires `stdin` to be connected to a terminal; if the bridge runs in the background or with redirected input, the toggle is not available.

6.9 Reading the PUS Debug Printout

With `-D` and `-P`, every packet is preceded by a time stamp and the direction of travel, followed by a decoded CCSDS and PUS-C header dump and a hex dump of the payload. An example for a telecommand (TC) with the debug output enabled is

```
[2026-09-10 10:20:30.512] NET->SPW
  CCSDS: type=TC APID=0x101 seq_flags=3 seq_count=42 data_len=35
  PUS-C: ST=5 SST=1 source_id=0x0000 ACK=0b0110
  CRC=OK
  payload (30 bytes):
  00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 0a 0b 0c 0d 0e 0f
  10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19
```

and for the corresponding telemetry (TM) return traffic

```
[2026-09-10 10:20:31.048] SPW->NET
  CCSDS: type=TM APID=0x088 seq_flags=3 seq_count=7 data_len=31
  PUS-C: ST=1 SST=33 MTC=4 DEST_ID=0x0005 T_REF_STS=0010 TS=5c:00:12:34:00:42
  CRC=OK
  payload (18 bytes):
  00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 0a 0b 0c 0d 0e 0f
  10 11
```

The printed fields are

`APID`	application process identifier of the CCSDS primary header
`type`	`TM` or `TC`
`seq_flags`, `seq_count`	CCSDS sequence flags and sequence count (decimal)
`data_len`	CCSDS data length in octets
`ST`, `SST`	PUS service type and subservice type
`source_id`	TC source identifier
`ACK`	TC acknowledgement flags, printed as four bits
`MTC`	TM message type counter
`DEST_ID`	TM destination identifier
`T_REF_STS`	TM time reference status, printed as four bits
`TS`	TM time, six-octet PUS-C time of day
`CRC`	result of the CRC16 check (`OK` or `NOK`, see Section 6.10)

The payload is dumped as hex octets, sixteen per line, with an empty line closing the dump. A payload that ends with a partial line is terminated properly, so every packet dump is followed by a blank line.

When `-d` drops leading header bytes from a received SpW packet, the dropped bytes are shown in the `SPW->NET` direction as an `SpW header (N bytes):` line directly below the direction line, in front of the decoded fields, so the stripped part of the packet remains visible in the log. The line is also printed in the short form and in the GRESB debug printout; monitor mode does not drop header bytes.

In monitor mode (Section 6.5) the dump shows the raw copied packet; with `-E` an RMAP header line (command or reply, read or write, addresses, transaction identifier, data length and the CRCs) is printed in its place.

6.10 The PUS CRC16 Check

Every PUS packet carries a CRC16 field, as mandated by ECSS-E-ST-70-41C. With `-P`, the bridge verifies this field on every packet in both directions and reports a failed check on `stderr`. The result is also printed in the debug dump as a `CRC=OK` or `CRC=NOK` line directly before the payload. The bridge never drops a packet with a failed check, it only reports it; it is a mediator on the data path. `-C` disables the check, which also suppresses the corresponding printout line. Disable it only when a mission-specific tailoring of the stream omits the CRC16 field.

6.11 The Pseudo-RMAP Interface

With `-R` (optionally followed by a port number, default 2345) the bridge starts a second TCP server that implements a simplified RMAP command interface. Each command has the form

```
<spw addr><op>:<addr>:<size>:<data>
```

encoded as a ten-byte header, followed by the write payload for write operations:

byte 0	target SpW logical address
byte 1	operation: 0 = read, non-zero = write
bytes 2–5	32-bit starting address, big-endian
bytes 6–9	data size, big-endian
bytes 10...	write payload (write operations only)

A read command issues a read of 5 bytes at the given address; the size field is currently ignored for reads. A write command writes the given payload with address increment. The RMAP commands are assembled with the STAR RMAP packet library, using a source logical address of `0x30` and the command key `0xab` without an extended address. The RMAP replies produced by a target (returned to `0x30`) are detected on the SpW link by their RMAP protocol identifier and forwarded to the connected RMAP clients in the same ten-byte-plus-data format.

For example, using netcat, a read of 5 bytes at address `0x1000` of a target with logical address `0xfe` is issued with

```
$ printf '\xfe\x00\x00\x00\x10\x00\x00\x00\x00\x00' |
    nc localhost 2345
```

and a two-byte write of `0xde 0xad` to the same address with

```
$ printf '\xfe\x01\x00\x00\x10\x00\x00\x00\x00\x02\xde\xad' |
    nc localhost 2345
```

6.12 Examples

6.12.1 Server Mode with a PCIe Card

Transmit and receive on channel 2 of the first detected device:

```
$ ./spw_bridge -c 2
```

6.12.2 Link Monitoring

To observe the traffic between two SpW targets connected to channels 1 and 2 of the same device, copy the packets verbatim between the channels and decode them as RMAP:

```
$ ./spw_bridge -M 1:2 -D -E
```

The network clients see a mirror of both directions of the copied traffic.

6.12.3 Brick MK II Configuration

The Brick MK II channel is always 1. Configure the signalling rate of link 2 and send packets via the route with id 2 to the remote SpW device with node address `0x14`:

```
$ ./spw_bridge -c 1 -n 2:14 -L 2
```

The same configuration in client mode, connecting to `localhost:1234`:

```
$ ./spw_bridge -c 1 -n 2:14 -L 2 -r localhost:1234
```

6.12.4 Use in the CHEOPS EGSE

With the real data processing unit (DPU) connected to the Electrical Ground Support Equipment (EGSE) Brick, use link 1 of the Brick as follows:

```
$ ./spw_bridge -c 1 -n 01:24:00:00:00 -d 4 -L 1 -p 5573 -P
```

and link 2 of the Brick accordingly:

```
$ ./spw_bridge -c 1 -n 02:24:00:00:00 -d 4 -L 2 -p 5573 -P
```

The first byte of the route is consumed by the Brick as the link number, the next byte is the address of the DPU (`0x24`) and the remaining three bytes are consumed by the DPU. The `-d 4` option drops the four-byte SpW address header that the real DPU attaches to its packets. Traffic is sent to local port 5573 in PUS framing mode.

6.12.5 Use in the ARIEL Mission

For the ARIEL mission, using a PCIe MK II card, the bridge is typically started as follows:

```
$ ./spw_bridge -i0 -P -n52:02:00:00 -p5573 -S60 -d4 -c3
```

This selects device number 0 (`-i 0`), parses the network byte stream as PUS packets (`-P`), uses the routing path `52:02:00:00` (`-n`), listens on local port 5573 (`-p 5573`), sets the link signalling rate to 60 Mbit/s (`-S 60`), drops the four-byte header of incoming SpW packets (`-d 4`) and opens SpW channel 3 (`-c 3`). The channel flag selects the physical SpW port of the card and may need adjustment depending on which port is wired to the target.

6.12.6 GRESB Protocol with grmon

For RMAP access through the grmon debug monitor, connect the target SpW link to a SpW port of the used device that supports RMAP (on the GR712RC only link 0 or link 1 support RMAP). Start the bridge with the GRESB option and set the link speed to 10 Mbit/s:

```
$ ./spw_bridge -c 1 -S 10 -G
```

The GRESB uses a base port number of 3000 with two ports per virtual link (the even port for transmit, the odd port for receive). In addition to the regular network port, the bridge raises the two ports of the selected virtual link itself, by default virtual link 0: port 3000 only sends copies of the GRESB packets that would be transmitted via the default port, port 3001 only receives packets which could also be received via the default port. Another virtual link is selected with the optional `LINKID` argument, e.g. `-G3` raises ports 3006 and 3007. No external forwarding is required. You may now start grmon against the machine that runs the bridge:

```
$ grmon -gresb 127.0.0.1
```

There is a caveat: the GRSPW2 SpW port of the target may not be initialised if no boot ROM is present. For the GR712RC you have to connect through the JTAG or another debug interface first and initialise the core, e.g. GRSPW0:

```
grmon> wmem 0x80100800 0xA0010006
grmon> wmem 0x8010080C 0x00000909
```

For details refer to the GRMON2 manual [8].